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## Home Is Where The Work Is

"SOFTWARE WRITERS WITH solid skills are finding plenty of jobs stateside," says Steve Hamm, and goes on to suggest that US programmers should not be stuck in routine programming jobs that could eventually be hijacked by Indian "upstarts"

Remember two years ago when the sky was falling for software programmers? Indian upstarts were putting tens of thousands of low-salary coders to work on projects that once would have been done by Americans.

But the latest data from the Bureau of Labor Statistics contain a pleasant surprise: The ranks of "computer and mathematical

occupations," which include many programmers, actually rose in the second quarter. While software companies themselves boosted jobs, employment at establishments providing custom programming services increased 5.6 per cent. By contrast, tech manufacturing jobs were up just a tad and telecoms are still cutting staff. Why the shift?

A couple of reasons. High-end programmers' skills are in demand as corporations adopt a slew of new technologies from wireless computing to

Web services—pieces of software that fit together like Lego blocks. That makes it easier to add new features and to integrate one program with another. A second factor: While Indian service firms and their Western rivals are hiring lots of programmers overseas, they're also recruiting people with design skills and business knowledge close to their clients in the U.S. and Europe.

But American programmers are not out of harm's way. The pressure is still on to avoid getting stuck in routine programming jobs that can easily be moved offshore.

### Smart Package Design

CMU's elite grads have had little trouble finding jobs. This is partly to the fact that CMU teaches them to design software packages, rather than just routine programming. But having the latest coding skills is vital, too. Rick A. Kessler, CIO of shipper Horizon Lines Inc., is nearly through a five-year project to retool Horizon's run-the-business applications using Microsoft Corp.'s Web services technologies. He's been hiring two to three highly skilled developers a month to help get the job done. They concentrate on translating business processes into a software design. Then he gets about 60 contract programmers, some in his offices and some in India and the Philippines, to do the routine coding.

The hot strategy for tech services companies these days is delivering services from around the world. This goes for giants like Accenture and IBM as well as the Indian upstarts. They staff software projects with a combination of U.S.-based programmers who make design decisions along with others in Asia, Eastern Europe, or even the US who can produce high-quality programming at a low price. India's Tata Consultancy Services, for instance, has 10 software centers in the US, plus eight others outside India.

Software likely won't be a jobs growth engine in the future. Still, so long as US companies continue to innovate and schools produce grads with top-flight skills, many American programmers will find jobs at home.

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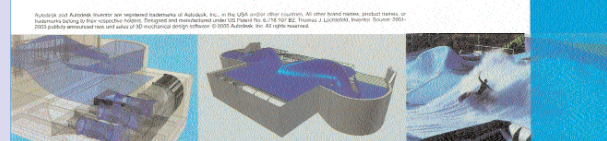
### Waikiki, Kansas.

#### Idea:

Design and create the perfect artificial wave for landlocked surfers.

#### Realized:

Wave track's Tom Ichniowski designed a pump system that molds 100,000 gallons of raging water into the perfect ride. His design tool: Autodesk Inventor® Series, the world's most powerful 3D design software. (Wave track's not in 3D.) From hanging in to getting in market in months, Autodesk® manufacturing solutions can help you realize your ideas to compete and win. To find out more, visit [autodesk.com/manufacturing](http://autodesk.com/manufacturing)



### Wild Surfing?

Surfer gone astray? Not quite. Autodesk, one of the world's leading motion picture digital manipulation software companies makes a strong point about their software: Realize your ideas. And no, Waikiki is still in Hawaii!

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